Motives for Imperialism Docs

1

Leroy-Beaulieu on the Desirability of Imperialism (1891)

The great value of colonies . . . is not only that they serve to catch the overflow population of the mother country, nor even that they open a particularly reliable area of investment for excess capital, it is also that they give a sharp stimulus to the commerce of the country, that they strengthen and support its industry and furnish to its inhabitants--industrialists, workers, consumer--a growth of profits, of wages, or of interest. But, . . . these advantages resulting from the prosperity of the colonies, are not limited just to the mother countries; they extend to all the countries of the old world and in fact there is not a nation which does not derive a real benefit from this increase in the productivity of humanity. . . .

Imperialism has caused the opening of new sources of production. . . . It is thus that unknown products have been brought to the consumers of Europe to increase their comfort. . . . That is the first and incontestable result of imperialism. And this is the second: It is to open the new markets for the sale of products manufactured in Europe, markets more profitable and more expandable than those we have been limited to previously, because the new societies have an ability to grow and to create and accumulate riches infinitely greater than the old societies. Thus trade is stimulated and extended, the division of labor is augmented [increased]; industry having before it wider openings can and must produce more and such production on a greater scale calls for new improvements and new advances….

2

US President Grant, 1870, on a treaty of annexation of the Dominican Republic

"The acquisition of the Dominican Republic is desirable because of its geographical position. It commands the entrance to the Caribbean Sea...It possesses the richest soil, best and most capacious [spacious] harbors, most salubrious [heathy] climate, and the most valuable products of the forest, mine, and soil of any of the West Indian Islands."

3

T. John Ruskin, Excerpt from Lecture at Oxford University, February 8, 1870

"[Will the] youths of England, make your country again a royal throne of kings . . . for all the world a source of light, a centre of peace? . . . This is what [England] must either do or perish; she must found colonies as fast and as far as she is able, formed of her most energetic and worthiest men; - seizing every piece of fruitful waste ground she can set her foot on, and there teaching these her colonists . . . that their first aim is to be to advance the power of England by land and be sea."

4

Friedrich Fabri, Does Germany Need Colonies? (1877)

"But should not the German nation who is . . . so very capable, so seaworthy, so industrially & commercially minded . . . successfully pave the way for this new course? . . . It would be wise if we . . . learn about colonial skills from our [English] cousins & would begin – in friendly competition . . .Should the New German Reich [empire] wish to prove & maintain its newly won position of power for a long time, it will have to take up the same culture-mission."

5

R. Henry Morton Stanley, English Writer & Explorer, Discussion with Birmingham Traders, 1878

"There are forty million naked people beyond that gateway [Africa] & the cotton spinners of Manchester are waiting to clothe them . . . & the ministers of Christ are zealous [eager] to bring the poor benighted [uneducated or ignorant] heathen into the Christian fold."

6

John G. Paton, a letter “Urging the Annexation of The South Sea Islands,” 1883

“The islands on this group are generally very rich in soil & in tropical products, as sugar cane is extensively cultivated on them by every native of the group, even in his heathen state . . . The islands also grow corn, cotton, coffee, arrowroot, & spices, etc . . . if any other nation takes possession of them, their excellent & spacious harbors…their near-proximity [closeness] to Great Britain’s Australasian colonies, would in time of war make them dangerous to British interests & commerce in the South Seas & her colonies.”

7

Excerpt from an article “Imperial Conquest: The Nation’s Savior,” printed in a daily Parisian newspaper, 1883

“The future & wealth of France depend above all on the extension & prosperity of our colonies. When factories produce more than consumers need [to buy], production must stop for a time, & workers must live off their savings…we lack of markets for our products. Once the French genius is put to colonization we will find an outlet for our factory surplus, & at the same time we will be able to secure the primary materials needed in our factories.”

8

Hinohara Shozo, Japan must not be an Oriental country, 1884

"Now, I want to change the direction of the argument and ask the reader this: do you wish to remain in the position of an Oriental for a long time and in the future forever suffer the shameful subjugation and reign of the Europeans? Or do you wish to leave the boundaries of Asia, join the ranks of Europe and America, and thereby evade [avoid] all future sorrows? The strong devour the weak."

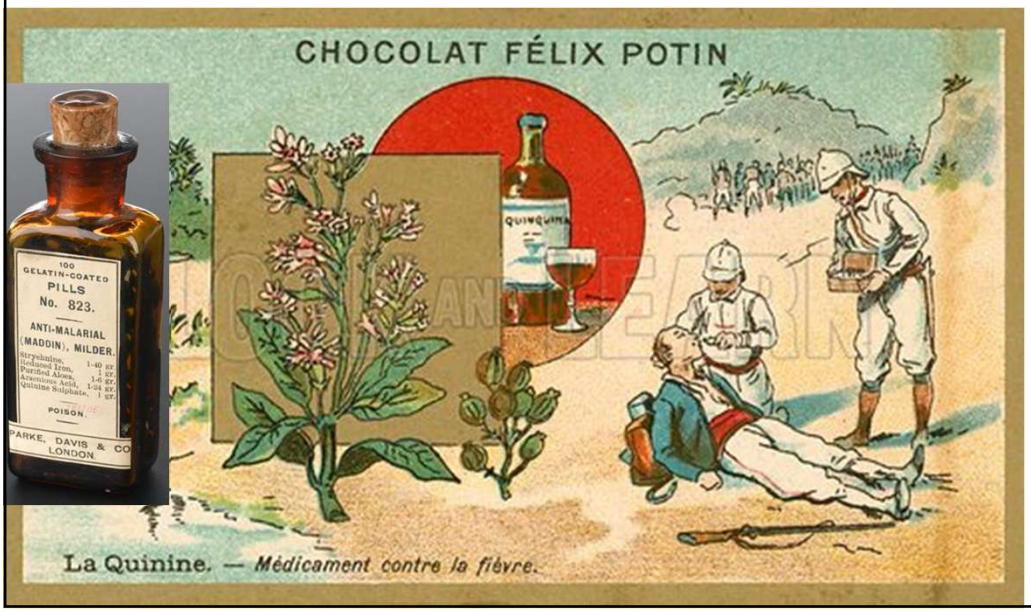
9

Japanese Prime Minister Ito Hirobumi, 1895

The aim of our country has been from the very beginning, to attain among the nations of the world the status of a civilized nation and to become a member of the comity [association[of European and American nations which occupy the position of civilized countries.

10

“Quinine, médicament contre la fièvre” (Quinine, fever reducing medicine)



In the 19th century, Europeans discovered that quinine can prevent malaria

“The gin and tonic has saved more Englishmen’s lives, and minds, than all the doctors in the Empire.”

-Sir Winston Churchill (tonic contains quinine)

11

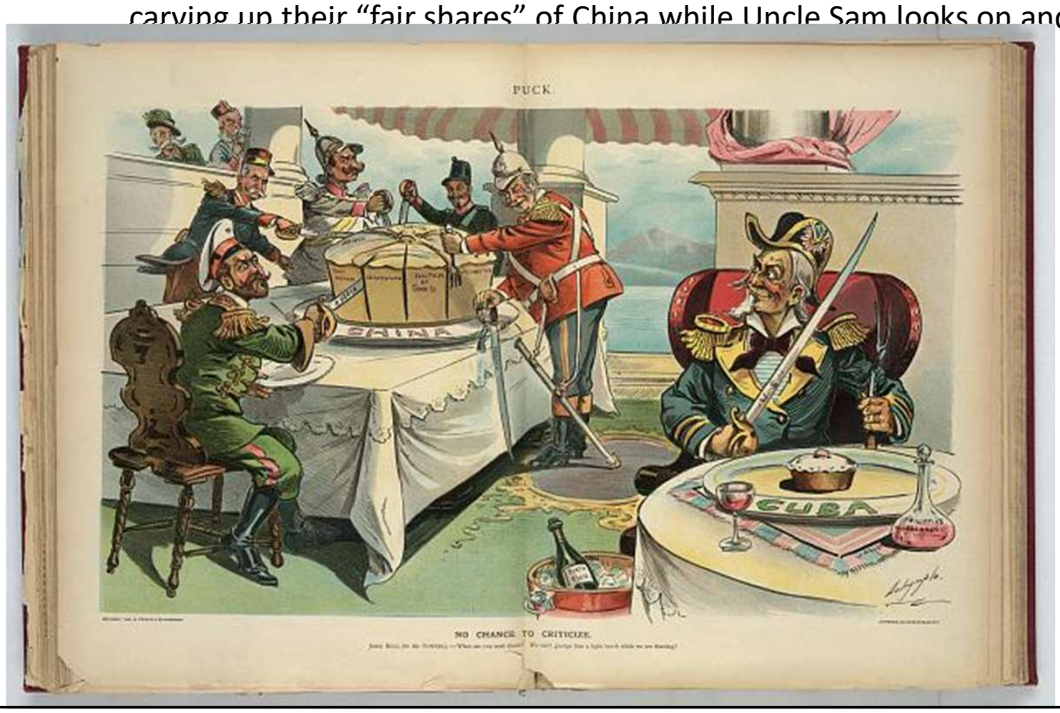
12

Joseph Chamberlain, Speech before Parliament on why Britain should occupy Egypt, where the Suez Canal linked the Mediterranean with the Nile River & Red Sea

"Britain must continue its occupation of Egypt because of the necessity for using every legitimate opportunity to extend our influence and control in that great African continent which is now being opened up to civilization and to commerce."

13

A political cartoon showing Russia, France, Germany, Japan, and England carving up their "fair shares" of China while Uncle Sam looks on and carves



14

French Prime Minister Jules Ferry, 1890

Colonial policy is the child of the industrial revolution. For wealthy countries where capital abounds and accumulates fast, where industry is expanding steadily, where even agriculture must become mechanized in order to survive, exports are essential for public prosperity [wealth]. Both demand for labor and scope for capital investment depend on the foreign market … new consumer markets will have to be created in other parts of the world. … Colonial policy is an international manifestation of the eternal laws of competition.

15

Josiah Strong, *Our Country: Its Possible Future and Its Present Crisis*. American Home Missionary Society, 1885

It seems to me that God, with infinite wisdom and skill, is training the Anglo-Saxon [white] race for an hour sure to come in the world's future… Then this race of unequaled energy, with all the majesty of numbers and the might of wealth behind it- the representative, let us hope, of the largest liberty, the purest Christianity, the highest civilization… will spread itself over the earth…This powerful race will move down upon Mexico, down upon Central and South America, out upon the islands of the sea, over upon Africa and beyond. And can any one doubt that the result of this competition of races will be the "survival of the fittest"?...

16

Indiana Senator Alfred Beveridge, March of the Flag, 1898

If England can govern foreign lands, so can America. If Germany can govern foreign lands, so can America. . . .

American factories are making more than the American people can use: American soil is producing more than they can consume. Fate has written our policy for us; the trade of the world must and shall be ours… We will establish trading posts throughout the world as distributing points for American products. We will cover the ocean with our merchant marine.

Ah! as our commerce spreads, [our] flag of liberty will circle the globe. . . . Benighted [ignorant] peoples will know that the voice of Liberty is speaking, at last, for them; that civilization is dawning, at last, for them. . . .

Fellow Americans, we are God's chosen people. . . .

17

Karl Pearson, British mathematics professor, *National Life from the Standpoint of Science*, 1900

"Australia nation is another case of a great civilization supplanting [replacing] a lower race unable to make full use of the land & its resources. The struggle means suffering, intense suffering...but that struggle & that suffering have been the stages by which the White man has reached his present stage of development, & they account for the fact that he no longer lives in caves & feeds on roots & nuts. This dependence of progress on the survival of the fitter race, terribly harsh as it may seem to some of you...is the fiery crucible [situation] out of which comes the finer metal."

18

US Navy Captain Alfred T. Mahan, *The Influence of Sea Power upon History*, (1890)

Whoever rules the waves rules the world... it cannot be too often insisted, a thoroughly strong navy can strengthen and ensure vital commerce….England's naval bases have been in all parts of the world; and her fleets have at once protected them, kept open the communications between them, and relied upon them for shelter...To provide resting places for the ships of war, where they can coal and repair, would be one of the first duties of a government proposing to itself the development of the power of the nation at sea."

19

UNCLE SAM—YOU FELLOWS WILL PLEASE STAND BACK WHILE I TRY THESE OYSTER SANDWICHES MYSELF.

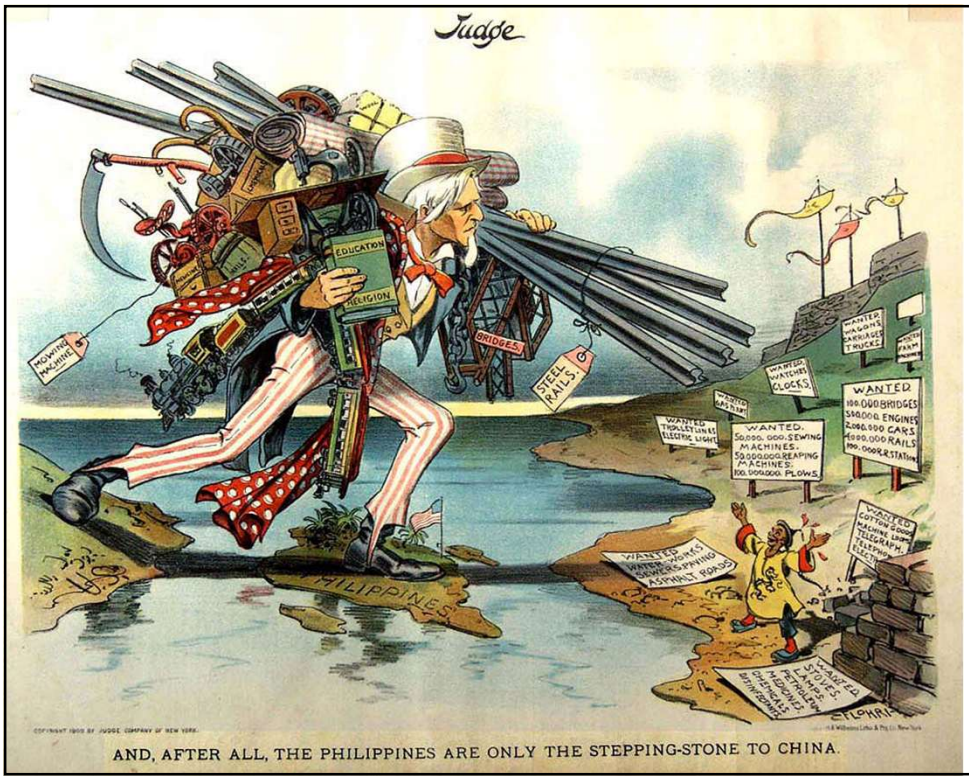
Uncle Sam tells England and Japan to back off while he helps himself to the Hawaiian Islands.

20

Henry Cabot Lodge, US Senator, 1898

Small states are of the past and have no future. The modern movement is all toward the concentration of people and territory into great nations and large dominions (self-governing territories). The great nations are rapidly absorbing for their future expansion and their present defense all the places of the earth. It is a movement which makes for civilization and advancement of the race. As one of the great nations of the world, the United States must not fall out of the line of march."

21



AND, AFTER ALL, THE PHILIPPINES ARE ONLY THE STEPPING-STONE TO CHINA.

"The Philippines Are Only the Stepping-Stone to China"

1898

22

"Whatever happens, we have got, the Maxim [gun], and they have not,"

British writer Hilaire Belloc, *The Modern Traveler*, 1898

Maxim Gun Detachment of the 1st Battalion, King's Royal Rifle Corps, Chitral Expedition, 1895, India

23

English poet Rudyard Kipling (author of *The Jungle Book)*, 1899
WHITE MAN'S BURDEN

Take up the White Man's burden,
Send forth the best ye breed
Go bind your sons to exile, to serve your captives' need;
To wait in heavy harness,
On fluttered folk & wild
Your new-caught, sullen peoples,
Half-devil & half-child.

Take up the White Man's burden—
And reap his old reward:
The blame of those ye better
The hate of those ye guard

24

25

In 1887, American businessmen in Hawaii forced King Kalakaua (at gunpoint) to sign a new constitution. A group of American sugar planters under Sanford Ballard Dole then overthrew Queen Liliuokalani, the Hawaiian monarch, and establish a new provincial government with Dole as president.

"So long as the islands retain their own independent government there remains the possibility that England or the Canadian Dominion might secure one of the Hawaiian harbors for a coaling station...There is not space allowed me in this article to speak of the vast importance of Hawaii to the future commercial power of the United States in the Pacific…"

Japanese contract workers on an American sugar plantation in Hawaii, 1895

26

Cecil Rhodes was a British politician and mining magnate. Rhodes proclaimed the superiority of the English: “"I contend that we are the first race in the world, and that the more of the world we inhabit the better it is for the human race…Why should we not form a secret society with but one object: the furtherance of the British Empire and the bringing of the whole world under British rule, for the recovery of the United States, for making the Anglo-Saxon race but one Empire?"

He and his British South Africa Company founded the southern African territory of Rhodesia (now Zimbabwe and Zambia). Rhodes monopolized the diamond industry, founding the De Beers Company.

The Rhodes Colossus,

27

“Now Will You be Good?” (Cuba and the Philippines), 1902

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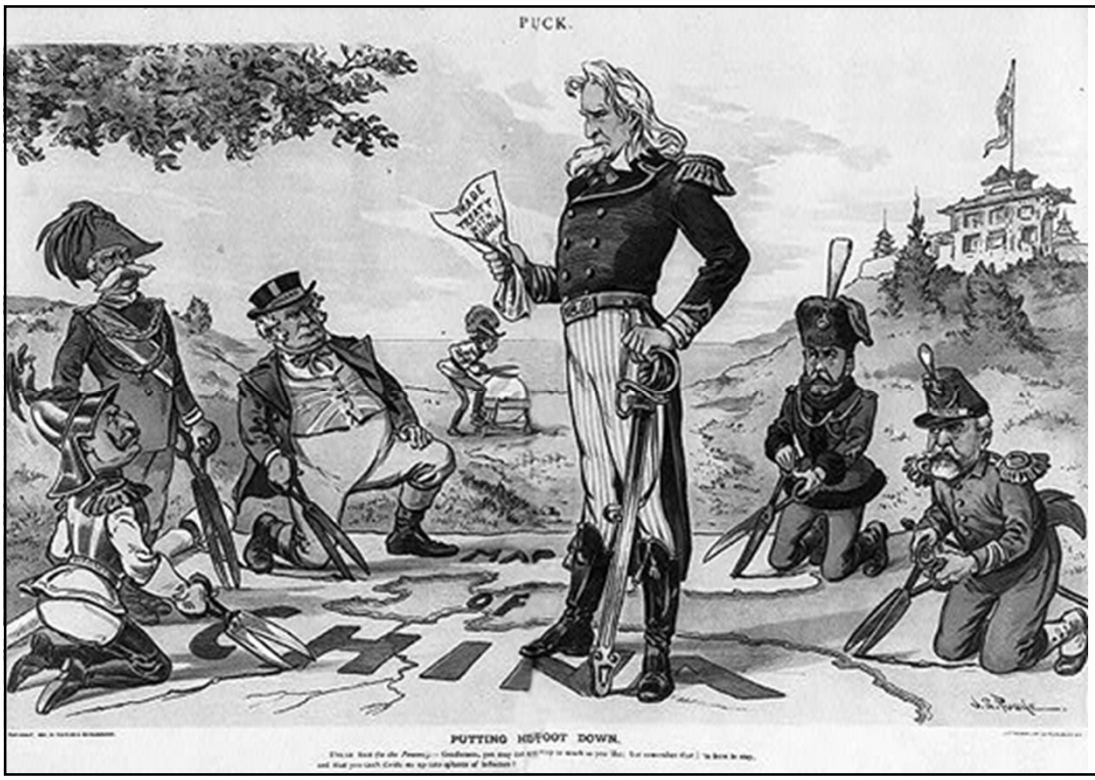

Putting His Foot Down

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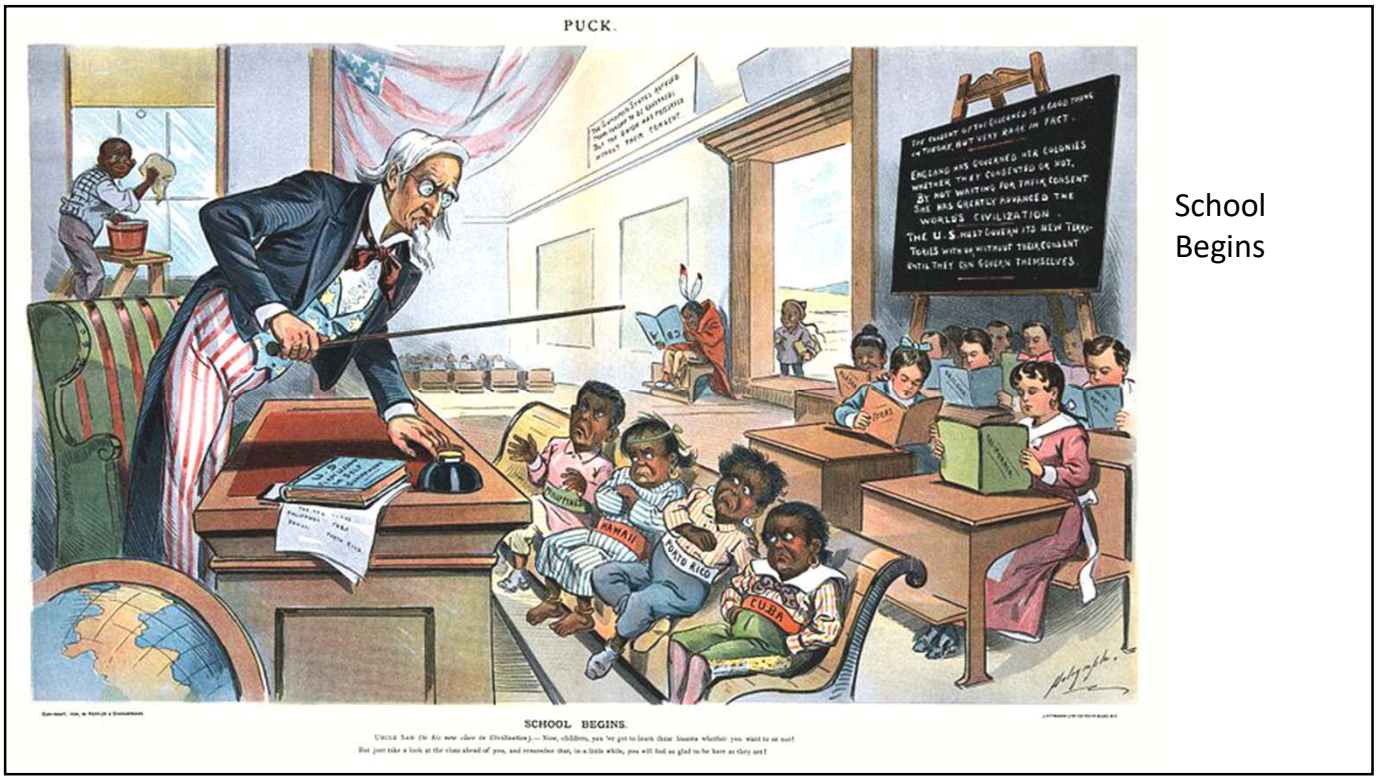

School Begins

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